

Tony Zhang

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science: Data Science, Undergraduate Minor: Robotics

GPA: 3.94|4.0

University of Utah | Salt Lake City, UT

Anticipated Graduation: April 2027

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

ARIA Lab – Robotics Center, University of Utah

July 2025 – Present

- Set up SO-101 robotic arms developed by LeRobot and implemented teleoperation pipelines to record demonstration episodes which were then uploaded to Hugging Face.
- Trained behavioral cloning diffusion policies locally using LeRobot's open-source framework.
- Preparing to evaluate ML security by perturbing camera inputs and testing the robustness of trained policies against adversarial manipulations.

Adler Lab – Mathematical Biology, University of Utah

January 2024 – May 2025

collaborations w/ Reeves Lab and Judson-Torres Lab – Huntsman Cancer Institute

- Developed computational simulations of tumor heterogeneity, including one and two-dimensional chemokine gradient models in R and C++ to replicate T-cell distributions observed in squamous cell carcinoma.
- Collaborated with the Reeves Lab to compare simulations results with experimental mouse model results in a visualization made in the scientific data visualization application, [ParaView](#).
- Partnered with Judson-Torres Lab to analyze melanoma cell interactions, using Python and R to study BRN-2 protein expressions among neighboring cells and to compare melanocyte vs. melanoma behaviors.
- Built and evaluated machine learning models (scikit-learn) to classify melanoma cell track quality from Quantitative Phase Imaging (QPI).

AWARDS

Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program (UROP)

Fall 2024 – Spring 2025

- Selected for a competitive undergraduate research funding program, receiving a stipend of \$1,200 for 120 hours of research work during each semester.
- Project Title: Modeling the Immune Response to Heterogeneous Tumors.

Dean's List

Fall 2023 – Spring 2025

- Earned for maintaining a GPA above 3.5/4.0 across 5 consecutive semesters.

Flagship Scholarship

Fall 2023 – Spring 2027

- Merit-based scholarship awarding \$3,500 per semester for Fall and Spring semesters over four years, totaling \$28,000.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Athletics Tutor – University of Utah Learning Center

Aug 2025- Present

- Provide academic support in math, physics, statistics, and computer science for both student athletes and the general campus population.
- Hold weekly recurring one-hour one-on-one tutoring sessions with 7 student-athletes, as well as offer additional appointment slots for the general student population on a non-recurring basis.

Package Handler – FedEx

Jul 2025 – Present

- Load, unload, and sort packages while following safety guidelines in a fast-paced warehouse environment.
- Gained experience in balancing work with academic and research commitments.